MIL-I-12718F
30 September 1985
SUPERSEDING
MIL-I-0012718E
23 August 1983

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

INSIGNIA, DISTINGUISHING, ARMY AND AIR FORCE, WOVEN

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers woven distinguishing insignia for the United States Army and the United States Air Force.

1.2 Classification. Woven insignia shall be of the following types as specified (see 6.2).

Type I - US Army
Type IA - US Army Desert Uniform
Type II - US Air Force - Full Color
Size 1 - Large
Size 2 - Small

Type IIA - US Air Force - Subdued
Size 1 - Large
Size 2 - Small

Type IIB - US Air Force - Desert Uniform
Size 1 - Large
Size 2 - Small

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specifications, standards, and handbooks. Unless otherwise specified, the following specifications, standards, and handbooks of the issue listed in that issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DODISS) specified in the solicitation form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be used in improving this document should be addressed to: Director, The Institute of Heraldry, US Army, Cameron Station, Alexandria, VA 22304-5050, by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

FSC 8455

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SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

PPP-B-566 - Boxes, Folding, Paperboard
PPP-B-621 - Boxes, Wood nailed and Lock-corner
PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard
PPP-B-676 - Boxes, Setup

STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-STD-191 - Textile, Test Methods

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-147 - Palletized Unit Loads
MIL-STD-794 - Parts & Equipment, Procedures for packing & packing of.

2.1.2 Other Government documents, drawings, and Publications. The following other government document documents, drawings, and publications form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

DRAWINGS

THE INSTITUTE OF HERALDRY

A-1-241 US Army Distinguishing Insignia
A-1-322 US Air Force Distinguishing Insignia, Large
A-1-678 US Air Force Distinguishing Insignia, Small

(Copies of specifications, standards, and drawings required by the contractor in connection with a specific procurement function should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer). (Figures 1,2, and 3 are miniature reproductions of drawings A-1-241, A-1-322, and A-1-678 and are for information purposes).

2.2 Other publications. The following document form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

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THE COLOR ASSOCIATION OF THE UNITED STATES

The Standard Color Reference of America, Tenth Edition.
United States Army Color Card, The Official Colors for Branches, Agencies, etc.
DOD Standard Shades for Heraldic Yarns for Embroidery and Ribbons, 1974.

(Application for copies of the color card should be addressed to The Color Association of the United States, 343 Lexington Avenue New York, NY 10016.)

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS

ASTM-D-3951 - Packaging, commercial

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this specification and the references cited herein, the text of this specification shall take precedence.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Guide samples. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), samples shall be furnished by the contracting officer to be used for guidance, information and as a standard for colorfastness. Variation from this specification may appear in the guide samples in which event the specification shall govern.

3.2 First article. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), before production is commenced, a sample of the finished item shall be submitted or made available to the contracting officer or his representative for inspection and/or testing as specified in 4.2. Approval of the first article sample authorizes the commencement of production but does not relieve the contractor of responsibility for compliance with all provisions of the specification. The samples shall be manufactured in the same facilities to be used for the manufacture of the production items.

3.3 Materials. Materials shall conform to the referenced specifications and the requirements specified herein.

3.3.1 Yarn. All yarns, both warp and filling shall be heat-set. The denier of the yarn shall be determined as it is received from the yarn producer and prior to adding twist, heat set, and finish.

3.3.1.1 Types I and IA. The yarn for types I and IA insignia shall be multifilament semidull polyester yarn (polyethylene glycol terephthalate). The yarn of the warp, including ground letters and selvage shall be 150 denier and the yarn for the filling shall be 70 denier.

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3.3.1.2 Type II and IIA. The yarn for types II and IIA insignia shall be a multifilament, semidull or bright polyester yarn (polyethylene glycol terephthalate). The yarn for the warp shall be 150 denier and the yarn for the filling shall be 100 denier.

3.3.1.3 Color. The yarn shall be dyed to match colors specified in Table I. The yarn may be solution dyed or yarn dyed with a dispersed dye. When ribbons contains two or more colors of yarn, each color may be all solution dyed or all yarn dyed, not mixed in the same color. The use of dyes and compounds containing elementary sulfuric acid is prohibited. The dyestuff shall be chosen and applied so that the dyed and finished yarn shall contain no more labile sulfur than shown by the standard sample tested as specified in 4.3. When a standard sample is not available, the dyed and finished ribbon shall no more than a slight trace of labile sulfur as defined in the test method, when tested as specified in 4.3.

TABLE I Color yarn.

Types	Background and filling		Letters	
	Color	Cable No.	Color	Cable No.
I	Olive HAJ	67134	Black HAN	67138
IA	Khaki HCS	67193	Spicebrown CHV	67196
II	Ultramarine Blue HS	67118	White HA	67101
IIA	Olive HAJ	67134	Flag Blue HY	67124
IIB	Khaki HCS	67193	Spicebrown HCV	67196

3.3.1.3.1 Colorfastness. When tested as specified in 4.3.3, the colorfastness of the finished insignia for wet-dry cleaning, bleaching, laundering and light shall be equal to, or better than, the colorfastness of the guide sample. When no guide sample is furnished, the colorfastness to wet-dry cleaning, bleaching, laundering, and light, shall be good.

3.3.1.3.2 Matching. The color shall match the approved standard shade under natural (North sky) daylight or artificial daylight having a color temperature of 7500 (plus or minus) 500 degree Kelvin. The color shall also be a good approximation to the standard shade under incadescent lamplight at 2800 (plus or minus) 100 degrees Kelvin.

3.4 Construction. The insignia shall be fabricated in accordance with the details and dimensions shown on figures 1, 2, and 3, as applicable.

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3.4.1 Physical requirements. Each insignia shall conform to the physical requirements listed in Table II.

TABLES II Physical requirements.

Types	Grounds	Thread Texture ends letters	Picks per inch
Types I and IA	208*	184	72
Types II and IIA and IIB, Size 1	212*	188	90
Type II, IIA and IIB, Size 2	200*	172	90

*Total ground ends to include 12 ends of selvage on each end.

3.4.2 Weave.

3.4.2.1 Types I and IA. The weave for types I and IA insignia shall be a three up and one down warp face twill. The warp shall be arranged end-and-end by color. The selvage shall be a 3 and 1 corkscrew weave.

3.4.2.2 Types II, IIA, and IIB. The weave for types II and IIA insignia in the ground and letters shall be seven up and one down, eight shaft warp satin with a 5 counter. The warp shall be arranged end-and-end by color. The selvage shall be 3 and 1 corkscrew weave.

3.4.2.3 Cutting mark. A variation in weave, to serve as a cutting mark, shall be permitted provided it is limited to an area no larger than 3/8 inch in the filling direction and 1/8 inch in the warp direction, centered between the end of one pattern and the beginning of the next pattern.

3.5 Finish. The reverse of the insignia shall be coated with a clear fabric finish which shall give the insignia a firm and stiff finish and shall not effect color of the yarn and not react adversely to storage, laundering, wet-dry cleaning, or ironing. The finish shall conform to the standard sample. The insignia shall be tested for stiffness as specified in paragraph 4.3.3, Table VI-Testing of end item. The minimum stiffness requirement shall be 100 x 10 - 4 inch pounds.

3.5.1 Cutting.

3.5.1.1 Types I, IA, II and IIA. Insignia shall be completely cut at right angles to the required length with a blade hot enough to obtain fused ends. The ends shall be sufficiently sealed to insure no break appears in the fused area when tested as specified in 4.4.1.

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3.6 Workmanship. The finished insignia shall be clean, well-made and shall meet the acceptable quality levels (AQL's) established by this specification.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Inspection responsibility. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier may use his own or any other facility suitable for the performance of the inspections specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Certificate of compliance. Where certificates of compliance are submitted, the Government reserves the right to check test such items to determine the validity of the certification.

4.2 First article of inspection. Unless otherwise specified, inspection and testing of the first article shall be made on a completely fabricated insignia for all provisions of this specification applicable to the end item product examination and test.

4.3 Inspection for acceptance. Inspection for acceptance shall be in accordance with the provisions of MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise specified.

4.3.1 Testing of component. In addition to the quality assurance provisions of the subsidiary specifications and drawings, inspection shall be performed on the yarn for the characteristics shown. Wherever applicable, the testing specified in FED-STD-191 and as specified in Table III, shall be followed. The lot size shall be expressed in units of one pound and the unit of product shall be one holder. The lot shall be unacceptable if one or more units fail to meet any requirement referenced in Table III. The sample size shall be as follows:

Lot size	Sample size
800 or less	2
801 to 22,000	3
over 22,000	5

When the data in the "#determ per unit of product" and "Results reported as" columns are not specified in Table III, they shall be required by the referenced test method.

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TABLE III Component testing.

Characteristic	Requirement paragraph	Test method	#determ per unit of product	results reported as
Material identification	3.3.1.1	1600*	-	Pass or fail
Material identification	3.3.1.2	1600*	-	Pass or fail
Denier	3.3.1.1 or 3.3.1.2	4021*	-	-
Color	3.3.1.3	Visual	1	Pass or fail
Labile sulfur	3.3.1.3	2020	1	Pass or fail

*Unless otherwise specified, a contractor's certification of compliance may be accepted as evidence of conformance.

4.3.2 Inspection of the item.

4.3.2.1 Visual examination. Defects found during the examination shall be scored in accordance with Table IV. The lot size shall be expressed in units of one insignia. The unit of product shall be one insignia. The sample size shall be in accordance with inspection level II and the AQL shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units.

TABLE IV Classification of defects.

Examine	Defects
Design	Any detail not as specified on figures 1,2, or 3, as applicable.
Material	Hole, float, broken end, slub, streak or running defect in material.
	Broken, cut or torn selvage edge.
Workmanship	Cut, tear or abrasion.
	Misshaped or distorted design.
	Lettering improperly centered between selvage and ends.
	Background showing through lettering.
	Permanent crease.
	Insignia askew.
	Weave variation (cutting mark) larger than 3/8 inch in filling direction and 1/8 inch in warp direction and not centered between beginning and ending of patterns.
	Spot, stain, or foreign matter on face.
Finish	Not correct color or shade as specified.
	Back not finished.
Heat sealing	Excessive unsealed fibers on ends (except at cutting marks).
	Face yarn discolored (due to heat sealing).

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4.3.2.2 Dimensional examination. Measurement defects shall be scored in accordance with Table V. The lot size shall be expressed in units of one insignia. The unit of product shall be one insignia. The sample size shall be in accordance with level S-3 and the AQL shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units.

TABLE V Classification of dimensional defects.

Examine	Defects
Height of letters	More than 25/32 inch or less than 23/32 inch.
Thickness of letters	Variation of more than 1/64 inch from requirement.
Overall length	Variation greater than authorized tolerance.
Overall width	Variation greater than authorized tolerance.

4.3.2.3 Examination for count. The following shall govern this examination:

Examination	Lot expressed in units of	Units of product	No of units	Sample size No. of units
a. #insignia per folding or set-up box	One folding or set-up box	One folding or set-up box	Up to 300 301 or over	4 5
b. #folding or set-up boxes per shipping container	One shipping container	One shipping container	Up to 3 4 to 6 7 and over	All 3 4

The lot shall be unacceptable if any of the following are found:

(a) Incorrect number of insignia per folding or set-up box.

(1) The average number of insignia per box in sample is less than specified or the quantity marked on the box.

(2) The number of insignia in any box is more than 5 percent under the quantity specified or the quantity marked on the box.

(b) Number of insignia per shipping container - actual number of insignia per container is less than specified, or less than quantity marked on container.

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4.3.3 Testing of end item. The methods of testing specified in FED-STD-191, wherever applicable and as listed in Table VI, shall be followed. When the data in "#determ per individual unit of product" and "results reported as" columns are not specified in Table vi, they shall be as required by the referenced test method. The lot size shall be expressed in units of one insignia. The unit of product shall be 8 insignia, for color, texture, colorfastness and weave tests. The lot shall be unacceptable if one or more units fail to meet the requirements referenced in Table VI. The sample size shall be as follows:

Lot size	Sample size
800 or less	2
801 to 22,000	3
over 22,000	5

TABLE VI Testing of end item.

Characteristic	Requirement reference	Test method	#determine per individual unit of product	Results reported as
Weave	3.4.2.1 or 3.4.2.2	Visual	1	Pass or fail
Texture ends (total)				
Ground	Table II	5050	1	Pass or fail
Letters	Table II	5050	1	Pass or fail
Selvage	Table II	5050	1	Pass or fail
Picks per inch	Table II	5050	-	-
Colorfastness and reaction of finish to:				
Wet-dry cleaning	3.3.1.3.1 and 3.5	5622 1/	-	-
Laundering	3.3.1.3.1 and 3.5	5614 1/	-	-
Bleaching	3.3.1.3.1	5600 1/	-	-
Light	3.3.1.3.1	5660 1/	-	-
Stiffness	3.5	5206	1	Pass or fail

1/ When no guide sample is furnished, results shall be reported as good, fair or poor. Also, test reports will be furnished for the initial inspection lot. A certificate of compliance will be accepted for each color of each subsequent lot on the same contract, provided the manufacturer certifies that the dyer or dye formulation has not been changed.

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4.3.4 Examination of preparation for delivery requirements. An examination shall be made to determine that packaging, packing, and marking requirements of section 5 of this specification are complied with. Defects shall be scored in accordance with items listed below. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully packed, selected just prior to the closing operation. Defects of closure listed below shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of containers in the inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units.

Examine	Defects
Marking (exterior and interior)	Omitted, incorrect, illegible, of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Material	Any component missing.
	Any component damaged, affecting serviceability.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of case liners, container flaps, loose strapping, inadequate stapling.
	Bulging or distortion of containers.

4.4 End item testing.

4.4.1 Test for fused ends. The insignia shall be firmly grasped on each side of the fused end with the thumb and forefinger and a 25 pound pull applied across the fused end. This pull test shall be performed on both ends of the insignia and the insignia shall be examined to determine compliance with 3.5.1.1.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A. Five hundred of one type and size only, shall be packaged in a set-up paperboard box conforming to type I, variety 1, class A, style 3 or 4 of PPP-B-676 or a folding paperbox conforming to variety 1, style III, type G, class I of PPP-B-566. Closure shall be in accordance with the appendix of the applicable box specification.

5.1.2 Level C. Distinguishing insignia shall be packaged to the MIL-STD-794 requirements for this level.

5.1.3 Commercial. Distinguishing insignia shall be packaged in accordance with the applicable requirements of ASTM D 3951.

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5.2 Packing. Packing shall be Level A, B, C or Commercial, as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Twenty thousand (40 Intermediate boxes) of one type and size of distinguishing insignia only packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting shipping container conforming to overseas type, Class 2, Style 2, Grade A, Type 1 load of PPP-B-621. Closure shall be in accordance with the appendix of the container specification. The weight of the contents of each shipping container shall not exceed the size and weight limitations of the container specification.

5.2.2 Level B. Twenty thousand (40 intermediate boxes) of one type and size of distinguishing insignia only packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting shipping container conforming to class weather resistant, V3s or V3c of PPP-B-636. Closure shall be in accordance with the appendix of the applicable container specification. The weight of the contents of each shipping container shall not exceed the size and weight limitations of the container specification.

5.2.3 Level C. Distinguishing insignia packaged, as specified in 5.1, shall be packed to the MIL-STD-794 requirements for this level.

5.2.4 Commercial. Distinguishing insignia, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in accordance with the applicable requirements of ASTM D 3951.

5.3 Marking. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129 or ASTM D 3951 as applicable.

5.4 Palletization. Unitized loads, commensurate with the level of packing specified in the contract or order, shall be palletized in accordance with MIL-STD-147. Palletized loads shall be uniform in size and quantities to the greatest extent possible. If the container is of a size which does not conform to any of the pallet patterns specified in MIL-STD-147, the pallet pattern used shall first be approved by the contracting officer.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. Insignia covered by this specification are intended to be worn on certain uniforms to designate the wearer is a member of the United States Army or the United States Air Force, as applicable.

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6.2 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.
(b) Type and size required (see 1.2).
(c) When a guide sample will not be furnished (see 3.1).
(d) When a first article is not required (see 3.2).
(e) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(f) When palletization is required (5.4).

6.3 Samples. For access to samples, address the contracting activity issuing the invitation for bids.

6.4 First article. First article samples shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of FAR 52.209. The first article should be a preproduction sample or initial production item. The contracting officer should specify the appropriate type of first article and the number of units to be furnished.

6.5 Changes from previous issue. Asterisks or vertical line are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue due to the extensiveness of the changes.

Custodians:
Army - IH
Air Force - 11

Review Activities:
Air Force - 82,99
Other - CT

User activitie:
Air Force - 45

Preparing activity:
Army - IH

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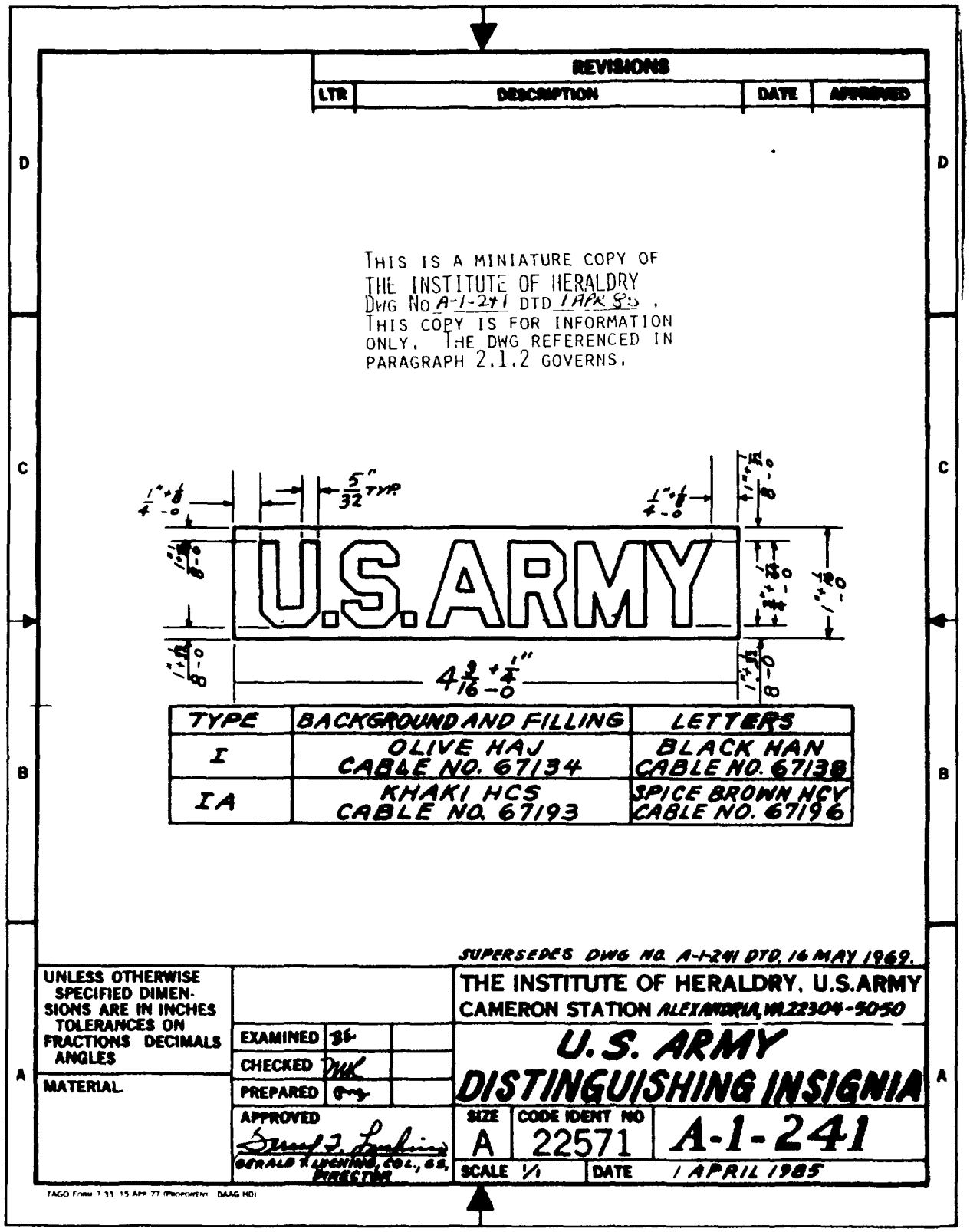


Figure 1

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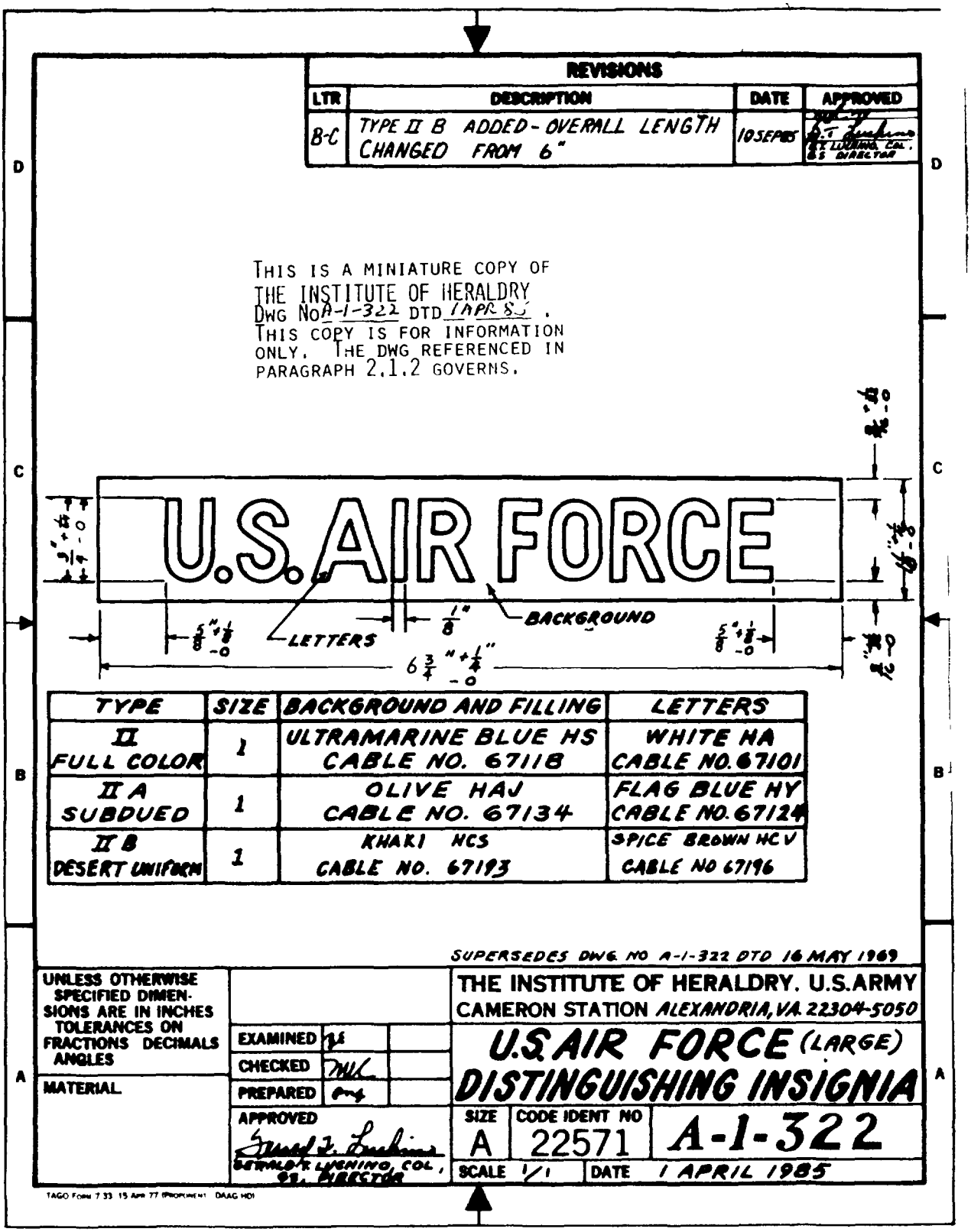


FIGURE 2

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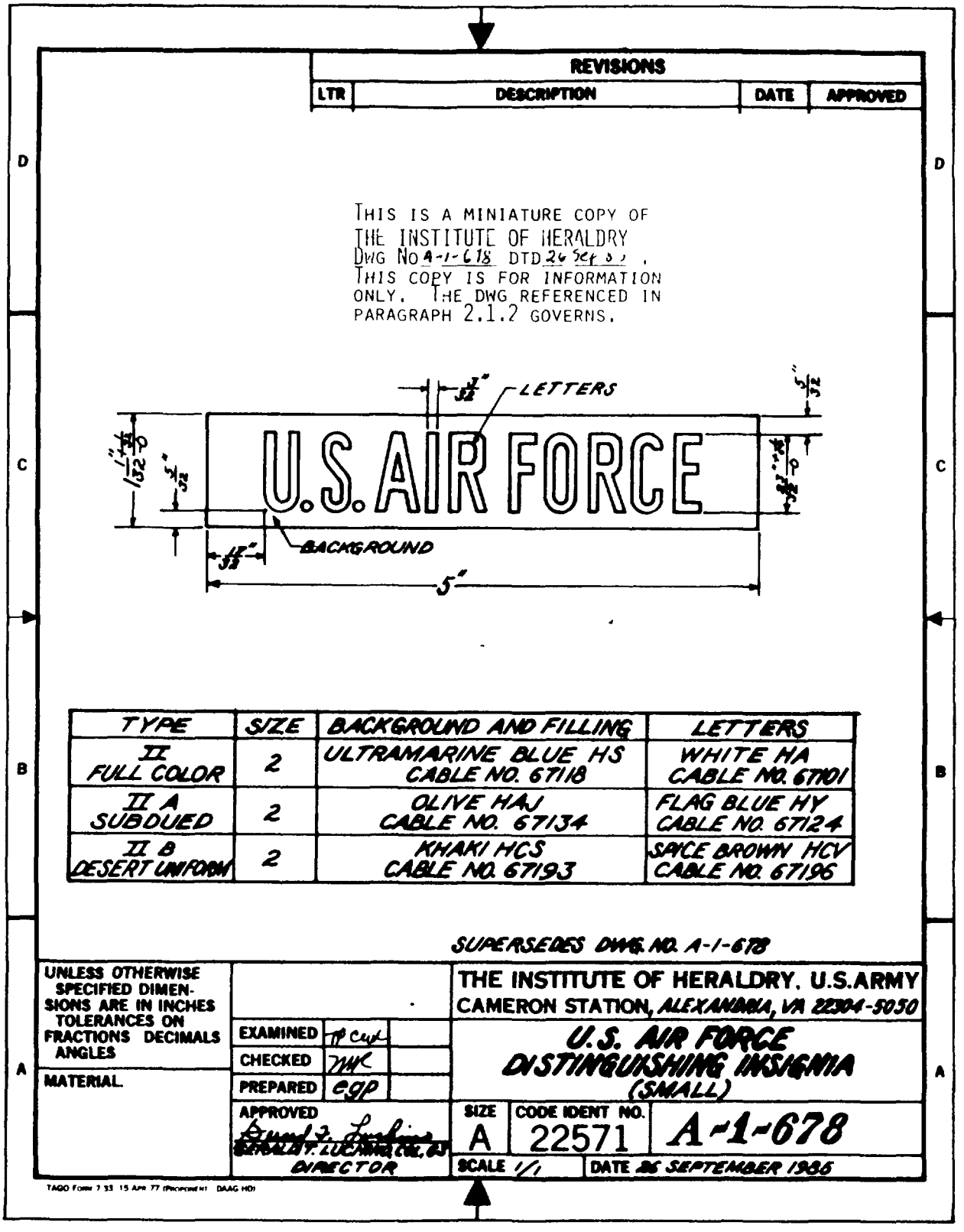


FIGURE 3

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INSTRUCTIONS. In a continuing effort to make our standardization documents better, the DoD provides this form for use in submitting comments and suggestions for improvements. All users of military standardization documents are invited to provide suggestions. This form may be detached, folded along the lines indicated, taped along the loose edge *(DO NOT STAPLE)*, and mailed. In block 5, be as specific as possible about particular problem areas such as wording which required interpretation, was too rigid, restrictive, loose, ambiguous, or was incompatible, and give proposed wording changes which would alleviate the problems. Enter in block 6 any remarks not related to a specific paragraph of the document. If block 7 is filled out, an acknowledgement will be mailed to you within 30 days to let you know that your comments were received and are being considered.

NOTE. This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document*(s)* or to amend contractual requirements.

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1 DOCUMENT NUMBER	2 DOCUMENT TITLE
MIL-I-12718F	Insignia, Distinguishing, Army and Air Force, Woven

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4 TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
b ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ USER
	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)* _____

5 PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording

b Recommended Wording

c Reason/Rationale for Recommendation

6 REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8 DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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